

Inequality Statement Sort

Unit 7: Equation Detective Agency · Lesson 7-4 · EduWonderLab

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7-4 · TEACHER NOTES

Standard 6.EE.8

FORMAT Sort + write

TIME 25–30 min

GROUPING Pairs

TOPIC Write Inequalities

STANDARD 6.EE.8

PREP LEVEL Light — print statement cards and symbol mat

Learning goal *I can write an inequality from a real-world statement and describe its solutions.*

Teacher setup

- Print one card set and symbol mat per pair. The mat has four zones: $<$, $>$, $\leq$, $\geq$.
- Students sort each statement, write the inequality, and describe the solutions.
- Use an “at most / at least” anchor chart.

Materials

Statement cards, Inequality symbol mat, Variable definition line, Pencil.

Differentiation & language support

- Anchor chart: at least $\rightarrow \geq$, at most $\rightarrow \leq$, more than $\rightarrow >$, fewer than $\rightarrow <$ (SPED).
- Sentence stem: “The solutions are all numbers that are ____.”
- ESOL: connect $\leq$ and $\geq$ to “or equal to.”

Key vocabulary (English / Español):

Term	Español	What it means
inequality	desigualdad	a statement comparing with $<$, $>$, $\leq$, or $\geq$
at least	al menos	greater than or equal to
at most	como máximo	less than or equal to

Quick teacher check: Check that “at least/at most” map to $\geq$ and $\leq$ (Cards 1, 3, 5, 7).

Inequality Statement Sort

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Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Your goal: *I can write an inequality from a real-world statement and describe its solutions.*

What you need

Statement cards, Symbol mat.

How to play

1. Read a statement card.
2. Choose the correct symbol: $<$, $>$, $\leq$, or $\geq$.
3. Write the inequality with a variable.
4. Describe what numbers make it true.

Statement Cards

Match each statement to its symbol, write the inequality, and describe the solutions.

1. You must be at least 12 years old to ride.	2. You can spend less than \$20.
3. There can be at most 5 guests.	4. More than 30 students attended.
5. You need to save at least \$50.	6. Fewer than 10 tickets are left.
7. The trip takes no more than 3 hours.	8. The score is greater than 100 points.

Record your work (inequality + solution meaning):

Explain your thinking

Explain the difference between “at least 12” and “more than 12.”

Sentence frame: *The solutions are all numbers that are ____.*

★ **Challenge:** Card 1 used $\geq$. Rewrite it as a “more than” statement and explain how the symbol changes.

ANSWER KEY

Teacher copy — please do not distribute to students.

UNIT 7 • LESSON 7-4 • Inequality Statement Sort

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Answers

1. You must be at least 12 years old to ride. Answer: $a \geq 12$	2. You can spend less than \$20. Answer: $c < 20$
3. There can be at most 5 guests. Answer: $g \leq 5$	4. More than 30 students attended. Answer: $s > 30$
5. You need to save at least \$50. Answer: $m \geq 50$	6. Fewer than 10 tickets are left. Answer: $t < 10$
7. The trip takes no more than 3 hours. Answer: $h \leq 3$	8. The score is greater than 100 points. Answer: $p > 100$

Teaching notes & look-fors

- “At least” $\rightarrow \geq$, “at most/no more than” $\rightarrow \leq$, “more than” $\rightarrow >$, “fewer/less than” $\rightarrow <$.
- $\geq$ and $\leq$ include the boundary value; $>$ and $<$ do not.